burdened with ethnocentrism without basis as a consequence of the coloniser's race-conscious approach to colonised societies. In other words, indigenous societies and their traditional social structures have been unfairly saddled with the West's new-found guilt complex in respect of its race consciousness. In this regard, the decolonial approach should be to understand such structures through the indigenous lens sans colonial biases, and it must be left to each indigenous society to determine the contemporary purchase of such structures based on its OET without being burdened by the guilt-racked conscience of the West. This would be consistent with decoloniality's commitment to diversity. This point shall be explained better in the context of discussions surrounding 'caste' and 'tribe' in and about Bharat in the next section of the book.

The sum and substance of the preceding discussion is that, wherever possible, without doing injustice to indigenous worldviews, a decolonial approach to indigeneity with an intent to preserve indigenous consciousness will be able to better navigate the seemingly uncomfortable yet inescapable realities, such as identifying the in-group and out-group, to the indigenous worldview. Unfortunately, the very suggestion to identify in- and out-groups is bound to ruffle quite a few feathers and invite criticisms of 'parochiality', 'narrow-mindedness' and so on and so forth, but the fact is that even in the contemporary 'modern' and 'liberal' world, these are the very issues that public discourse, law and policymaking revolve around, especially when questions of heritage, identity and access to resources are involved. Neither modernity nor liberalism has been able to do away with 'identity politics'. If anything, their innate coloniality has pushed such discussions further into the arms of ethnocentrism, particularly in indigenous societies like Bharat. Consequently, since othering is a reality of life that cannot be avoided, it is better to do so on the basis of consciousness as opposed to 'identity'. Accordingly, from a decolonial perspective, it would help to define indigeneity on the basis of consciousness instead of identity.

Having said this, throughout the discussion undertaken thus far, I have used 'indigenous/indigeneity' to distinguish the coloniser from the colonised. I have also attempted to explain that decoloniality's approach to indigeneity is primarily OET-centric as opposed to being purely ethnocentric since ethnocentrism and race-consciousness are central to coloniality. In the interest of honesty, conceptual clarity and consistency,